

COM278 DIGITAL COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

*Assignment 2: Website Analysis Report on
Ascending Hope Website*

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COM278 Digital Communication Strategy

Assignment 2: Website Analysis Report

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Introduction

Ascending Hope is a community services organisation founded in 2016 with their initial focus on addressing the issues of gambling. Over time, the organisation has evolved into providing more comprehensive social services to the needy and underprivileged in Singapore (Ascending Hope Community Service, 2025). On the first look, Ascending Hope's website may give off the message that there is still hope to become "clean" from gambling with the use of colours such as white, blue, and red. The overall layout and design of the website is easy to navigate and filled with information. In this report, the main goal is to evaluate the website's digital communication strategy and develop recommendations that are suitable for the organisation to improve the website's performance while remaining competitive and relevant.

Section A: Website's Analysis

Target Audience

Ascending Hope offers features on their website encouraging its audiences to volunteer, donate, and sign up for their community programmes such as Senior Care, Family Support, as well as Gamblers Recovery Support. Moreover, their website users can look up for more information regarding each programme to get a better understanding about their contributions by clicking the “more info” button on the same page (Refer to Appendix 1). Based on these online features, we can determine that Ascending Hope aims to target:

- People who lives in Singapore
- Singaporeans who would like to learn more about social services
- Singaporeans who are passionate about volunteer work
- Singaporeans who are keen to donate to those in need
- Senior members living in Singapore who are fighting loneliness
- Families in Singapore who are struggling financially
- People who are battling with gambling addiction
- English-speakers

Additionally, there are features like contacting them for potential sponsorships and partnerships on their website under the “Get Involved” section. Hence, other potential target audiences of Ascending Hope’s website includes:

- Businesses and organisations who seek to support charity
- Food Suppliers
- Product Manufacturers
- Community Centres (CC)

- Residents' Committees (RC)
- People's Association (PA)

Underlying Aim of Website

Before we begin the analysis, it is important to understand that the underlying aim of the website represents the core purpose of their existing design, layout, and content (Team ME, 2023). According to the website, it is believed that the underlying aim of Ascending Hope is to empower and uplift Singapore's most vulnerable people and families. The website stated that their mission and vision is to guarantee that no one is left behind in the society through a variety of initiatives and programmes hosted by the organisation. Additionally, they also intend to work towards creating a long-lasting and constructive social change in Singapore. Under the "About Us" section on their website, information about their community connections and strategic alliances are provided to their target audience. This further shows that through their efforts in collaborations and partnerships, they are able to keep promoting positive change and fostering hope and caring for those in need within the community.

Website's Main Message and Call to Action

On the other hand, the main message and call to action of the website involves specific and measurable steps taken in order to achieve their aim mentioned above. Ascending Hope is conveying their main message of 'Hope is where the heart is'. Their main message is encouraging to people who are struggling and people who want to contribute in helping them. Moreover, it reinforces their mission to bring meaningful change through compassion.

According to the website, Ascending Hope encourages their visitors to take impactful call to actions by donating, volunteering or getting involved, and learning more about their programme at their home page. These actions are easily accessible for visitors and can all be done by visiting their home page and click on the relevant buttons. The 3 impactful call to actions can be broken down into different purposes below:

- 'Donate Now'
 - Looks for potential sponsors and invites financial contributions
- 'Volunteer or Get Involved'
 - Encourages personal dedication and make lasting, positive change
- 'Learn More'
 - Guide users to detailed pages of their programmes like 'Food for Hope' and 'Hopeline', where they can explore services and find appropriate involvement opportunities

Main Strategy

The main strategy underpinning Ascending Hope's website is a mission-driven, emotionally compelling engagement strategy that blends storytelling, service visibility, and clear action pathways to build trust, drive community participation, and generate financial contributions. Ascending Hope's website is very mission and community-centric where clear value proposition and call to actions are applied. This can be seen from their main message 'Hope is where the heart is' that is eye-catching and appears directly in the front page of their website. Furthermore, the call to actions mentioned above are always visible on their website which reduces friction in the user journey and results in positive user experience. According to an article (Designity, 2025), it is essential for a successful website to have an excellent user experience as it keeps visitors happy and likely to continue browsing from the website.

One of the other website's main strategies leans heavily on emotional engagement which showcases stories about past gambling survivors, personal testimonials filled with community photos and visuals to build empathy. This strategy helps foster a connection with visitors and encourages them to take part in their contribution. Nonetheless, the website also displays service visibility and accessibility by making it easy for users and visitors to understand what services are offered and which support matches their needs or interests. The programme information are summarised in a clear manner with "More info" buttons to ensure that visitors are engaged without confusion or information overload (Refer to Appendix 2). Overall, the current main strategies used in Ascending Hope's website are effective for their community with impactful ways that emotionally resonate with its users while providing a seamless path to support those in need.

Other Online Tactics Used

Based on my analysis, Ascending Hope's website uses several online tactics to strengthen its digital presence, engage its users, and drive support to its visitors. These tactics are mostly subtle but strategically integrated to match the organisation's community-centric value. Some key online tactics they adopted are:

1. Website optimisation

The website uses emotionally appealing banners with titles and taglines such as 'Touching lives, Inspiring hope', 'Bringing warmth to seniors', 'Hope for every child's future', and more (Refer to Appendix 3). With the use of these titles and taglines, it creates impactful meaning to visitors and users as it touches the heart and encourages them to contribute to a good cause. Furthermore, real-life images were also used to create empathy. Thus, this increases user engagement and conversion to action such as donating or volunteering.

2. Donation integration with payment gateway

It can be seen that the organisation is aiming to gather more donations as the website has various buttons that leads to the donation page. The prominent 'Donate Now' button links directly to a secure donation platform via Giving.sg (Refer to Appendix 4). This ensures easy, trusted, and quick donations, which is essential for fundraising.

3. External platform linkages

At the bottom of every page on their website, Ascending Hope uses external platforms like Giving.sg and social media pages to funnel traffic back to their site (Refer to Appendix 5). This further encourages users to visit their other pages for upcoming events or volunteer work. Moreover, it also allows the organisation to reach a broader audience.

4. Email and contact integration

With buttons for users to directly sign up for donations or volunteering activities, there are contact form and email options that enables outreach to service users, volunteer inquiries, and donor follow-ups. In addition, this also supports basic email marketing follow-ups.

5. Search engine optimisation (SEO)

The website is filled with page titles that are common keywords related to the topic which enhances the SEO searches. Furthermore, the use of Singapore's local language and terms such as "Singapore families in need" can improve local SEO visibility and increase the chance to match local search queries.

Unused Tactics

There are some unused online tactics that matches the concept and strategy of Ascending Hope's website which can be useful to the website. For example, Ascending Hope can publish a blog or short video series showcasing staff, field workers, and their day-to-day challenges preparing for the volunteering activities. This fosters empathy and builds connection with potential donors and volunteers. Another tactic that may be useful to improve Ascending Hope's website is promoting user-generated content campaigns by launching hashtags for users to engage in sharing their personal stories or photos of how they engage with Ascending Hope. This tactic also increases visibility and authenticity through community-driven marketing which matches with Ascending Hope's mission.

Section B: Suggestions

Key Strategic Recommendations

Through the analysis above, it can be seen that Ascending Hope's website is very engaging and effective to the organisation. Below are some key strategic recommendations tailored for Ascending Hope to include in their website:

1. Content Strategy

It is recommended that Ascending Hope can develop a consistent content calendar for blogs and updates including success stories of recovered gamblers, volunteer spotlights and interviews. This implementation allows donors and stakeholders to see ongoing activities and participate or contribute accordingly.

2. Email Marketing

It is possible for Ascending Hope to integrate email newsletter sign-ups and offer downloadable online resources such as reports on gambling issues. It is recommended to upload resources every bi-weekly to ensure that the users are continuously engaged in the topic and events. Additionally, Ascending Hope can send out occasional event invitations like the organisation's anniversary to provide a sense of belonging to its users.

3. Multilingual and Accessibility Features

As a community organisation, Ascending Hope can consider making their website accessible in multiple languages as Singapore is a multi-racial country. In addition, it is suggested to making the vision-impaired users feel included by adding accessibility features on their website to ensure that they can browse through easily. This is important for the organisation as it helps to reach a larger audience by including local communities and the less fortunate.

4. Improve Visual Storytelling

Through digitalisation, it is suggested to create and publish short videos across their social media platforms and website as it was proven that 77% of the younger generations especially Gen Z feel more engaged and prefer when there are interactive visuals on the website (BW Online Bureau, 2024). By focusing on improving their visual storytelling, it can reconnect emotionally and continue to build stronger credibility with its visitors.

5. Enhance Mobile Optimisation

With a significant portion of traffic coming from mobile users, it is recommended that Ascending Hope can optimise mobile navigation and ensure that their call to actions buttons leads to the pages in a fast speed that can reduce having a high bounce rate. With an increased loading speed and optimised touchscreen usability, visitors would continue to browse the website and visit Ascending Hope's website frequently due to the ease of accessibility.

References

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<https://www.bwmarketingworld.com/article/77-gen-z-prefer-augmented-reality-interactive-visuals-report-536477>

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<https://red-website-design.co.uk/marketing-basics-18-online-and-offline-tactics-every-business-should-use/>

Appendices

Appendix 1:



SENIOR CARE

- Free haircuts
- Food ration distribution
- Bread distribution @Whampoa
- Home refurbishing and cleaning

MORE INFO



FAMILY SUPPORT

- Single Moms, UNITE!
- Free tuition for children
- Basic needs assistance
- Emotional support
- Free legal advice

MORE INFO

Ascending Hope Community Services. (2025). *Programmes*.

<https://www.ascendinghope.org/programmes>

Appendix 2:



Food for Hope is a programme dedicated to distribution of food and necessity items to the elderly and needy families. Our mission is to enliven lives with warmth and care to those we serve. Our distribution work is supported by volunteers who adopt a 'chat and check' approach to actively engage in conversations during deliveries. These visits create valuable interactions to convey care and assurance. Our donors and sponsors donate cash, meals and provisions to enable us to create meaningful connections to bring hope to individuals and families facing challenging circumstances.

MORE INFO →



Hopeline is a helpline service, accessible via WhatsApp, Facebook, Instagram, and Telegram, to assist gamblers and their families with services and support to help rebuild lives and break free from the burdens of financial distress and gambling addiction. This service helps individuals who may feel alone or overwhelmed and to encourage them to make the first step towards recovery. Our Hope Buddies are available to guide help seekers from Monday to Friday, 9am to 5pm.

MORE INFO →

Ascending Hope Community Services. (2025). <https://www.ascendinghope.org>

Appendix 3:

TOUCHING LIVES **INSPIRING HOPE**

Our dedication to empowering individuals and communities through care and interaction.



HAPPINESS
Bringing Warmth To Seniors

Giving love, care, and connection in their golden years.

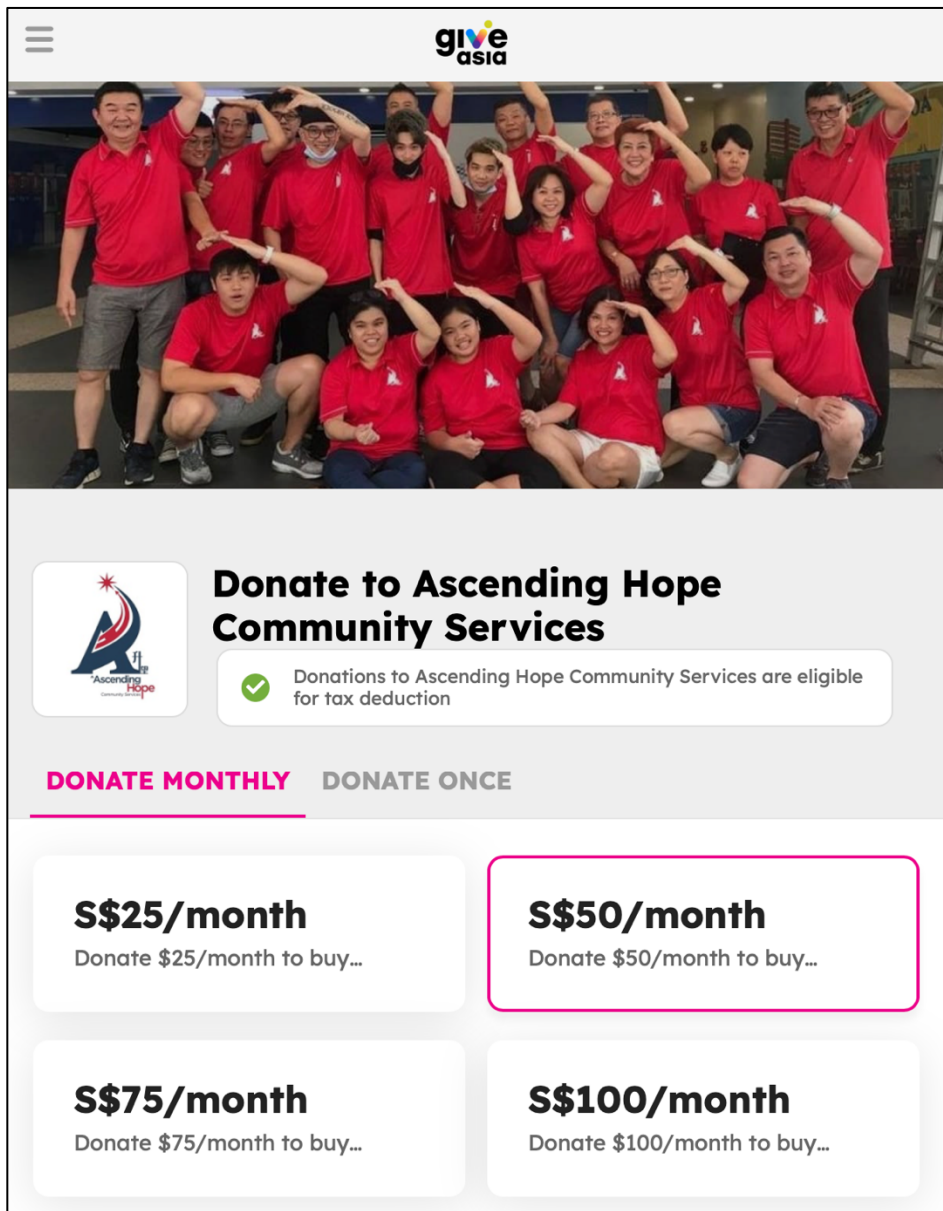


HARMONY
Hope for Every Child's Future

Supporting families with free counselling, tuition and enrichment activities.

Ascending Hope Community Services. (2025). <https://www.ascendinghope.org>

Appendix 4:



Give Asia. (2025). *Donate to Ascending Hope Community Services.*

<https://give.asia/charity/ascendinghope>

Appendix 5:

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Ascending Hope Community Services. (2025). <https://www.ascendinghope.org>